



THE MADE REAL BLUEPRINT · PORTUGAL EDITION

My Blueprint

Phase 1 · Choose it

Anna · 9 October 2026

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT HOLDS

1. My decision, in one page
2. The money, from first guess to checked figure
3. What does not line up yet, and what happens next
4. My Working Direction, My Explore Summary, My Decision in full

Your decision in one page

Everything after this page is the evidence behind it, in your own words.

MY DECISION

Go and move

Am I ready to rent a house with land near Góis for twelve months, from June 2027?

On condition that: The flat is rented out before I sign anything in Portugal, and the €8,000 reserve stays untouched.

THE PLACE

A rented house with land in the Serra do Açor, inland from Coimbra – around Góis, Arganil or Pampilhosa da Serra.

Portugal · Coimbra district · around Góis

THE MONEY

29 months

EUR 2,360 a month, EUR 1,650 income, EUR 21,000 put aside

MY FIVE GREEN LIGHTS

Money

Amber

Papers

Green

People

Amber

Place

Green

Plan B

Green

MY FIRST STEP

Sign the twelve-month rental on the house near Góis, after the November visit.

4 May 2027

I LOOK AT THIS AGAIN

1 December 2027, after the first winter

The money, from first guess to checked figure

You wrote these numbers weeks apart. This is the only place they sit side by side.

Step 1	EUR 2,245	what you thought a month would cost
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Step 2	EUR 2,360	what you found, against real prices
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Income	EUR 1,650	what you can count on each month
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Put aside	EUR 21,000	savings you can reach within a month
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You are **EUR 710 short each month**, which your savings cover for about **29 months**.
That is your runway if nothing changes.

What changed along the way

In Step 1 you wanted

I want to wake with the light in a small house with land, and work three mornings a week at the bookkeeping I am good at. I want two hours outside every day and people close enough to eat with. I want to stop being afraid of January.

In Step 2 you chose

A rented house with land in the Serra do Açor, inland from Coimbra — around Góis, Arganil or Pampilhosa da Serra.

In Step 3 you decided

Go and move

Every figure on this page comes from your own answers. Nothing is estimated for you.

What does not line up yet

Not advice — just the places where two things you wrote yourself do not yet agree. Each one names where it came from.



People is amber, without a date

Lotte and I agree the dates I come back each year

Step 3 · Part 1 — an amber light needs a next action and a date



Nothing on your list is broken

All 6 you checked are met, or partly met.

Step 3 · 4.1 — checked against the list you wrote in Step 1



An unknown you carried through

Whether the fibre holds in a storm. What the house really costs to heat in January.
Whether I will still want this in my third winter.

Step 2 · My Explore Summary — still written down as unknown

What happens next

Your own dates, in order. Nothing here was chosen for you.



MARCH 2027

Move the bookkeeping fully online
your timeline · Step 3 · 3.1



DONE, 4 MARCH 2027

Residency file checked by my lawyer and ready to send
Papers · Step 3 · Part 1



14 MARCH 2027

Book a second visit in November, alone, for ten days
your next small step · Step 2 · My Explore Summary



APRIL 2027

Rent out my flat, rather than sell it
your timeline · Step 3 · 3.1



APRIL 2027

Give notice at the office, three months
your timeline · Step 3 · 3.1

● **MAY 2027**

Sign the twelve-month rental near Góis
your timeline · Step 3 · 3.1

● **4 MAY 2027**

Sign the twelve-month rental on the house near Góis, after the November visit.
your first step · Step 3 · 4.2

● **JUNE 2027**

Apply for residency
your timeline · Step 3 · 3.1

● **30 JUNE 2027**

Two remote clients signed, or €200 off the monthly costs
Money · Step 3 · Part 1

● **1 DECEMBER 2027, AFTER THE FIRST WINTER**

Look at this decision again, whatever has happened
your review date · Step 3 · 4.2

● **DONE**

The November visit confirmed the house and the village
Place · Step 3 · Part 1

● **DONE**

The flat is rented out for the first year, not sold
Plan B · Step 3 · Part 1

Step 4, Prepare, turns this into a moving plan. Until then, this is your plan.

STEP 1 · PICTURE

My Working Direction

Anna

My life picture in three sentences

I want to wake with the light in a small house with land, and work three mornings a week at the bookkeeping I am good at. I want two hours outside every day and people close enough to eat with. I want to stop being afraid of January.

What I choose now

A direction to investigate

The direction(s) I want to explore

Renting a small house with land inland from Coimbra, around Góis or Arganil, for a year before buying anything.

Why: two or three reasons

It meets every essential I wrote down. It is reversible, so a wrong answer costs me a year and not my savings. And the money check says I can carry the gap for about three years, which is long enough to find out properly.

My essential needs: I take these with me

Outside space of my own. Internet I can work on. A doctor within half an hour. A day's travel to my sister. Neighbours.

Assumptions I still need to check

That the internet is good enough to keep my clients. That €780 really rents a house with land. That I can bear February there alone. That my clients do not mind the address.

What I need to learn next

What a winter inland is actually like. Real monthly figures from two people who live there. What the residency paperwork takes, in weeks.

What I am willing to invest: time, money, comfort

The office salary, €1,250 a month. The car. Two hours a week on Portuguese. Being near my sister every Sunday. I am not willing to give up my reserve of €8,000.

Who can help me

My sister Lotte, Rui and Ineke in Góis, my oldest client Hendrik

The first question I will investigate, and why it matters most

Can I work from there to the standard my clients pay for? It matters most because every other part of the plan rests on that €1,650 continuing.

My next small step, within two weeks

Book six weeks inland in February and ask for Thursdays at home

What this step will help me learn

Whether the winter, the internet and the quiet are real or imagined

Date of this step

20 October 2026

When I will review what I learned

The first week of April 2027, after the six weeks

What result would make me continue, change direction, or stop

Continue if I can work two full weeks from there without a single apology to a client, and if February does not frighten me. Change direction if the internet fails. Stop if six weeks alone there makes me lonely rather than quiet.

In two years, how I will know this worked

I will know it worked if I am outside two hours a day, if January 2029 does not frighten me, and if someone in the village knows how I take my coffee.

people

Person: Lotte, my sister, Shared wishes: That I should stop postponing this, Where we differ: She wants me a day's drive away, not a flight, Open concerns: Who is here if our mother gets worse, What we agreed: I come back three times a year, dates fixed in advance |
Person: Hendrik, my oldest client, Shared wishes: The work matters, the address does not, Where we differ: He wants one week a year in person, Open concerns: Response time in his busy month, What we agreed: I fly over in March every year, at my own cost

STEP 2 · EXPLORE

My Explore Summary

Anna

The place I want to explore further

A rented house with land in the Serra do Açor, inland from Coimbra — around Góis, Arganil or Pampilhosa da Serra.

Country, region, nearest town

Portugal · Coimbra district · around Góis

Three reasons it fits my picture

It has the outside space and the daylight. The fibre is real, so my clients never notice. And it is a day from my sister: a flight to Porto and two hours on the road.

What it does not give me, and how I deal with that

It does not give me a market town on the doorstep. The nearest proper market is twenty-five minutes away, and I have decided I can live with that.

What a normal month costs there

About €2,360 a month, checked against real bills in February rather than brochure figures.

How my income will work there

€1,650 confirmed from the three clients. Everything above that is hoped for, not counted.

My legal route, and what I must prove

Residency as a self-employed person. I must prove steady income, health cover and an address.

Healthcare: how it works for me

Private cover for the first year, then the public system once I am registered.

What is still unknown

Whether the fibre holds in a storm. What the house really costs to heat in January. Whether I will still want this in my third winter.

Who I need: people, advisers, contacts

A Portuguese accountant, Rui and Ineke in the village, and my own lawyer for the paperwork.

What I choose now

Go further with this place

My next small step, within two weeks

Book a second visit in November, alone, for ten days

Date of this step

14 March 2027

When I will review what I learned

Mid-December 2027

STEP 3 · DECIDE

My Decision

Anna

check

My must-haves and dealbreakers (Step 1): Outside space of my own, Does this option meet it?: Yes, Known / estimate / unknown: Known | My must-haves and dealbreakers (Step 1): Fast, reliable internet, Does this option meet it?: Yes, Known / estimate / unknown: Estimate | My must-haves and dealbreakers (Step 1): A doctor within 30 minutes, Does this option meet it?: Yes, Known / estimate / unknown: Known | My must-haves and dealbreakers (Step 1): Reachable from the Netherlands in a day, Does this option meet it?: Yes, Known / estimate / unknown: Known | My must-haves and dealbreakers (Step 1): Neighbours, not isolation, Does this option meet it?: Partly, Known / estimate / unknown: Estimate | My must-haves and dealbreakers (Step 1): A town with a market, Does this option meet it?: Yes, Known / estimate / unknown: Known

My decision question (from the Start)

Am I ready to rent a house with land near Góis for twelve months, from June 2027?

My decision

Go and move

Must-haves met, and no dealbreakers broken?

All four essentials are met and no dealbreaker is broken. Neighbours is only partly met, and I accept that for a year.

Why: my three main reasons

The money works: a 29-month runway even before a single new client. The place held up on a second visit, in winter, alone. And staying costs me another four years of the same week.

My lights: which are green, which are amber, and which are red

Papers, Place and Plan B are green. Money stays amber until two clients sign. People stays amber until Lotte and I fix the dates.

Conditions that must be true before the big steps

The flat is rented out before I sign anything in Portugal, and the €8,000 reserve stays untouched.

Who decided with me, and do we agree?

Lotte knows and agrees. Hendrik has confirmed the work continues wherever I sit.

My first step

Sign the twelve-month rental on the house near Góis, after the November visit.

Date of my first step

4 May 2027

When will I review this decision?

1 December 2027, after the first winter

What would make me change it?

If neither new client signs by June and the costs hold at €2,360, I postpone by six months rather than start on a shrinking runway.

**You will never be completely sure.
But you can be ready enough, and know what to do next.**

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